

AI Use Policy

1. Purpose

This policy defines the rules for the safe, effective, and responsible use of artificial intelligence tools at Langate. Its purpose is to enable employees and contractors to benefit from AI in day-to-day work while protecting client confidentiality, company intellectual property, personal data, and system security.

Langate supports practical use of AI, including a bring your own tool model, provided that such use complies with this policy, client obligations, applicable law, and Langate security requirements.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and other personnel who use AI tools for or in connection with work performed for Langate or its clients.

It applies to:

- generative AI tools;
- AI coding assistants;
- AI-enabled search, summarization, transcription, and analytics tools;
- locally hosted, SaaS, API-based, and embedded AI features;
- both company-provided and personally selected tools used for work purposes.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

All Personnel

- comply with this policy;
- protect confidential information;
- verify AI outputs;
- seek approval when needed;
- report incidents promptly.

Managers and Delivery Leads

- ensure teams understand client-specific restrictions;
- support safe adoption of AI in delivery processes;
- escalate unclear or high-risk use cases.

Security / Privacy / Legal

- maintain guidance on approved and restricted tools;
- review sensitive or exceptional use cases;
- support incident response and contractual interpretation.

4. Guiding Principles

Langate allows AI use under the following principles:

1. **Client trust comes first.** AI use must not violate client contracts, statements of work, NDAs, security schedules, or client instructions.
2. **Use AI to assist, not to replace accountability.** The user remains responsible for the quality, legality, security, and accuracy of all outputs.
3. **Disable model training by default.** AI should not be allowed to use your content for training (where the tool provides such a setting).
4. **Input only the minimum necessary data.** Do not send sensitive information into AI unless explicitly allowed and adequately protected.
5. **Bringing your own tools is allowed, but requires approval.** Personnel may use their preferred AI tools for work only if those tools meet the requirements in this policy and have been approved for use.
6. **Free-tier LLM models and AI tools are generally not allowed.** The exception is open-source tools deployed to the company-managed environment. Use of 3rd-party MCP, skills, and plugins requires review and whitelisting.
7. **Higher risk requires higher control.** Uses involving sensitive data, production-impacting decisions, or external deliverables require additional review and caution.

Personnel may use AI tools for work when the use is not prohibited by this policy, complies with client and legal requirements, uses an approved or properly reviewed tool, and follows the data handling and human review rules below.

5. Definitions

For the purpose of this policy:

AI Tool means any software or service that uses machine learning or similar techniques to generate, transform, classify, summarize, or analyze content.

Langate Data means any non-public information relating to Langate, including source code, architecture, financial information, internal documents, security information, and business plans.

Client Data means any information received from or created for a client, including code, documentation, tickets, designs, datasets, credentials, and business information.

Sensitive Data means any of the following:

- source code not intended for public release;
- credentials, API keys, tokens, certificates, secrets, or connection strings;
- personal data;
- protected health information, payment card data, or other regulated data;
- client confidential information;
- security findings, vulnerabilities, incident details, penetration test results;
- unreleased product, roadmap, pricing, or M&A information.

Approved Tool means an AI tool that Langate has centrally reviewed and approved for broader business use.

Permitted Personal Tool means a non-company AI tool selected by an individual under the bring your own tool model that satisfies the minimum requirements of this policy.

6. Prohibited Uses

The following are prohibited unless explicitly approved in writing through the Chief Operating Officer (COO) and, where relevant, by the client:

1. Inputting Sensitive Data into an AI tool that does not meet the requirements of this policy.
2. Inputting client data into any AI tool where:
 - the client has prohibited such use;
 - the relevant agreement does not allow it where consent is required;
 - the tool provider may retain the data for training or unrelated purposes;
 - the tool does not provide adequate security and confidentiality protections.
3. Inputting secrets of any kind into external AI tools.
4. Using AI output for final work product, material business decisions, or production code without qualified human review and normal approval controls.
5. Using AI in a way that infringes intellectual property rights, violates licenses, or breaches client ownership terms.
6. Using AI to create deceptive, misleading, discriminatory, harassing, or unlawful content.
7. Circumventing security controls, access restrictions, client instructions, or company policies through AI use.
8. Uploading entire repositories, databases, logs, tickets, contracts, or documents to AI tools unless expressly permitted and appropriately protected.

7. Bring Your Own Tool

Langate permits the use of personally selected AI tools for work under a controlled bring your own tool model.

Company-designated AI services are listed in **Appendix A**. Personally selected AI tools listed in **Appendix B** are approved by default for work use, subject to this policy, client restrictions, and proper security configuration.

Any AI tool not listed in **Appendix A** or **Appendix B** is not approved by default and must not be used for work until approved through the Chief Operating Officer (COO). The COO may request supporting information and involve Security, Legal, the DPO, the Client Account Owner, or the client before approval is granted.

Before using a personal AI tool for work, the user must confirm that the tool is approved and that any available setting allowing provider training or service improvement on submitted data is disabled.

Use of any personal AI tool with Sensitive Data or Client Data requires COO approval unless the tool is already explicitly approved for that specific use.

Langate reserves the right to remove a tool from the approved-by-default list, restrict its scope of use, or require additional approval based on legal, security, contractual, or client-specific concerns.

8. Data Handling Rules

8.1 Default Rule

Assume that anything entered into an AI tool may leave your local environment unless you know and are authorized otherwise.

8.2 What You May Enter Without Special Approval

You may enter:

- public information;
- synthetic or mock data;
- anonymized examples that cannot reasonably be linked back to a person, client, system, or project;
- small excerpts of non-sensitive text or code where necessary and permitted.

8.3 What You Must Not Enter Without Approval

You must not enter:

- client names if the context is confidential;
- source code from private repositories;
- tickets, specifications, or documents containing client confidential information;

- credentials or secrets;
- personal data;
- security logs, vulnerability details, or incident information;
- proprietary algorithms, architecture diagrams, or non-public designs;
- any data classified as confidential or restricted under company or client policies.

8.4 Data Minimization

Where AI use is permitted, only provide the minimum amount of information necessary. Prefer:

- summarizing rather than pasting raw documents;
- pseudonymization and anonymization;
- redaction of names, identifiers, hosts, keys, and URLs;
- isolated snippets rather than full files or repositories.

9. Client-Specific Requirements

Where client rules are stricter than this policy, the stricter rules apply.

Project managers, account owners, and delivery leads must ensure that each client engagement clearly indicates one of the following statuses:

- **AI Allowed** – subject to this policy.
- **AI Allowed with Restrictions** – subject to specific client conditions.
- **AI Prohibited** – no AI use for that client's data, code, or deliverables.

If the client's position is unclear, personnel must treat the engagement as **AI Allowed with Restrictions** and avoid using client data until clarified.

10. Code Generation and Engineering Use

AI may be used to assist software development, but the following rules apply:

1. AI-generated code must go through normal engineering controls, including code review, testing, dependency checks, and security scanning.
2. Do not paste private source code, internal libraries, or client code into an external AI tool unless explicitly approved.
3. Do not use AI-generated code that creates licensing, security, or third-party rights concerns.
4. Use extra caution for:
 - authentication and authorization logic;
 - cryptography;
 - infrastructure as code;
 - data access controls;

- security-sensitive scripts;
- production migrations;
- compliance-related functionality.

11. Quality, Accuracy, and Human Review

AI systems may produce incorrect, incomplete, outdated, biased, insecure, or fabricated outputs. For that reason:

- substantive outputs must be reviewed by a competent human before use;
- factual claims, citations, references, and quotations must be verified;
- legal, regulatory, security, and architectural guidance must be reviewed by the relevant experts;
- client-facing and external deliverables must meet the same standard as non-AI-assisted work.

Responsibility for final output always remains with the employee or contractor and the relevant approval chain.

12. Intellectual Property and Ownership

Personnel must not assume that AI-generated content is free of third-party rights or automatically owned by Langate or the client.

Before using AI-generated content in deliverables, codebases, proposals, or product materials, users must consider:

- client contract terms on ownership and subcontracting;
- third-party provider terms;
- possible copyright, database, trademark, or license issues;
- whether the output may be too similar to existing material.

Where there is uncertainty, consult [Legal / Delivery Lead].

13. Transparency and Disclosure

Internal disclosure of AI use is encouraged where it helps risk management, quality control, or client trust.

Personnel must disclose AI use when:

- a client contract requires it;
- the client asks;
- the use materially affected a deliverable;

- the use involved sensitive workflows or regulated data;
- internal approval processes require documentation.

Langate does not require disclosure for trivial assistance such as grammar improvements, formatting, or brainstorming, unless client terms say otherwise.

14. Administrative Requirements

Langate may maintain records of approved tools, client restrictions, exceptions, approvals, and AI-related incidents, and may monitor company-managed AI tools and systems for security, compliance, and misuse consistent with applicable law and company policy.

Any suspected or actual incident involving AI use must be reported promptly in accordance with Langate's incident reporting policy.

Exceptions to this policy require documented approval through the Chief Operating Officer (COO) and, where relevant, from the client. Exceptions should define the tool, use case, data involved, risk assessment, safeguards, and approval period.

Violations of this policy may result in removal of access, corrective action, contractual consequences, disciplinary measures, or other appropriate action, depending on severity.

Appendix A – Standard Corporate AI Tools

Langate may provide or designate certain AI tools as standard corporate tools for general business use.

The following tool is designated as a standard corporate AI tool:

- Microsoft Copilot, including Copilot functionality made available through Microsoft Teams.

Standard corporate AI tools remain subject to this policy, applicable client restrictions, and any Langate-administered security, privacy, and access controls.

Appendix B – Approved Bring Your Own Tool List

Langate permits the following AI tools (except free-tiers) for work use by default under the bring your own tool model:

- GitHub Copilot
- Claude Code
- Cursor
- ChatGPT

- Claude
- Gemini

These tools are **approved by default for work use** only when used in accordance with this policy, client restrictions, and proper security configuration, including disabling any available setting that allows provider training or service improvement on submitted data.

Any AI tool **not listed in this Appendix** is **not approved by default** and must not be used for work until it has been approved through the COO approval process in accordance with the rest of this policy.